



**RURAL INVESTMENT
COLLABORATIVE®**

Small towns, big opportunities.®

Community Investment Training: 2027 Application

Deadline: July 10th, 2026

Additional Background Information and Project Narrative

Secondary Point of Contact:

Secondary Email Address:

Secondary Phone Number:

Secondary Phone Number Type:

Title/Organization:

Project Information

Required

Project Type:

Required

Project Location (County):

Required

Project(s) Summary: Your project summary should be a concise statement that includes key details such as the project objective, desired outcome, problem addressed, and core partners. (Word Count: 100)

e.g., My project is to restore a vacant property in our downtown to prepare it for sale to a private investor. The property is part of the town's strategic plan for community development. Once renovated, the property would be sold and the income from the sale would be used to work on the next property in the plan. Key partners include the town, chamber of commerce, and a local foundation.

e.g., My project is to increase the amount of available lodging for tourism. Tourism is a large part of our economy, but visitors currently stay in a neighboring county/town. By completing the [Hotel, Inn, Cottages] project, our town will increase its daily occupancy by about [#] rooms. Key partners include the tourism authority, chamber of commerce, and county administration.

e.g., My project is to increase the amount of workforce housing in order to retain/attract workers for our hospital. Health care is a primary employer in our region, but the nurses are not able to afford housing within commuting distance to the hospital. We are working with the hospital, nursing school, and local housing authority to create a mixed-income housing development.



Required

Project Narrative

Narrative: In **400 words or less**, please describe the project in a way that someone with no familiarity will be able to understand. Please address the prompts below.

- a. What is the project?
- b. What are the community or economic development needs of the town, community, or people in the project area that are addressed by this project?
- c. What industry or economic sector is most related to the project? What role will the project play for that sector?
- d. What community asset does the project build upon? What assets, advocates, research, or other resources are critical to the project's success?
- e. What are the anticipated challenges? How will you address or mitigate these risks?



Required

Criteria 1: Soundness of Project Approach

1. How will community residents benefit from the project? Will the project result in local ownership? Please address if and how the project will benefit low- and moderate-income residents as part of the response. **(200 Words)**



Required

2. What community outcomes will occur if the project is successful? **(200 Words)**

Required



3. How will you measure project progress and impact? **(150 Words)**

Required

4. What is the timeline for the project? Please include major phases. **(150 Words)**

Required



Criteria 2: Readiness to Proceed

5. What public organization(s) is supporting your application (e.g. municipality, chamber, planning district, nonprofit, etc.)? Is the project part of an existing strategic plan or community planning document? **(150 Words)**

Required

6. How has the community been part of developing a shared vision for this project? How will you continue to engage the community during the training if selected? **(150 Words)**

Required



7. How do you know there is a need and demand for this project from the local community (e.g. market study, feasibility studies, or other evidence)? **(150 Words)**

Required

8. What makes this the right time for your project? What evidence do you have that there is momentum or excitement to get this project done? (e.g. funding commitments, partner agreements, site control, state/local priorities, etc.) **(200 Words)**

Required



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Required

Criteria 3: Training Fit

10. What are the specific capital improvements you anticipate for this project? (e.g. building renovations, purchasing land, purchasing buildings, purchasing equipment, etc.) **(150 Words)**

Required



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11. What earned income opportunities do you expect as a result of the project? What other types of funding are you willing to explore? (e.g., debts/loans: banks/financial institutions, community development financial institutions, foundations, government; equity: low-income housing tax credits, new markets tax credits, historic tax credits; grants: individuals, corporations, foundations, government) **(150 Words)**

Required

12. Why are you interested in this training? How could you see yourself using this training beyond the project you work on during the course? What is your current level of knowledge about community development finance and how to access different types of investments (e.g., loans, tax credits, etc.) **(200 Words)**

Required



13. Why are you interested in this training? How could you see yourself using this training beyond the project you work on during the course? What is your current level of knowledge about community development finance and how to access different types of investments (e.g., loans, tax credits, etc.) **(200 Words)**

Required

14. How can you help build the capacity of your community by participating in this training? **(150 Words)**

Required



Additional Questions

Required 1. If employed, is your employer supportive of your participation in the training?

Required 2. Please upload one letter of support from a community-based partner that is NOT your employer.

3. Please upload any strategic planning documents that demonstrate the need and/or include the proposed project as part of the solution. (This could include things like a community development plan, economic development plan, Main Street revitalization plan, community health needs assessment, etc.)

Required 4. Virtual training sessions will be held weekly from 2-4 p.m. ET on Mondays. The training will run from January to May, 2027. Attending with your camera on and actively participating in each session is required. You are allowed two absences during the training but must view the recording and complete the homework. All participants must complete the pitch session. Will you be able to meet these requirements?

Required 5. How did you hear about this training? (Who and organization if applicable)

**Optional upload: Readiness matrix/checklist*